James Higgins

TECHNICAL PROJECT MANAGER & FULL-STACK DEVELOPER

Vancouver, BC

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Available for full-time or contract Technical Project Manager roles and web development contracts

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Technical project management, grounded in 12+ years of hands-on development.

I lead web projects from scoping and estimation through launch and long-term support, coordinating designers, developers, content creators and QA. Because I have built WordPress, PHP and e-commerce platforms myself, my estimates reflect how the work actually gets done, my architecture and DevOps guidance is practical, and developers get clear answers without a hand-off.

I hold every project to the same standard: disciplined version control, repeatable deployments, documented decisions and clean handovers.

Selected work

PROVINCE OF BRITISH COLUMBIA

BritishColumbia.ca (https://www.britishcolumbia.ca/)

Led the development phase of the province's redesign and migration to WordPress, including multilingual support with WPML. Delivered under Falcon Software's IBM partnership.

Technical Project Manager · Falcon Software

HEALTHSTREAM

HealthStream.com (https://www.healthstream.com/)

Managed the redevelopment of the corporate site for a US healthcare workforce company, introducing a card-based system of reusable components alongside custom widgets and features.

Technical Project Manager · Falcon Software

HEALTH SCIENCES ASSOCIATION OF SASKATCHEWAN

HSAS.ca (https://www.hsas.ca/)

Launched a WooCommerce merchandise store and redeveloped the members' collective agreement browser. Now leading the rebuild of the association's information portal.

Technical Project Manager · Falcon Software

Experience

Technical Project Manager

Falcon Software Company Inc. September 2020 – present

- Manage web projects for public-sector, healthcare and member-organization clients, now delivered through Falcon's KPMG partnership, owning scope, estimates, schedule and stakeholder reporting.
- Led IBM partner projects for the Government of British Columbia, including the development phase of the BritishColumbia.ca redesign and WordPress migration with multilingual support through WPML.
- Managed the redevelopment of HealthStream.com, introducing a card-based system of reusable components alongside custom widgets and features.
- For the Health Sciences Association of Saskatchewan, launched a WooCommerce merchandise store, redeveloped the collective agreement browser, and currently lead the rebuild of the member information portal.
- Provide fine-grained time and cost estimates, advise on code architecture and DevOps strategy, and direct UX and UI decisions with client stakeholders.

Tools: WordPress, WooCommerce, WPML, Kentico, Sitefinity, Jira, Microsoft Azure, WP Engine, UnderStrap, Microsoft Teams

Technical Project Manager

NativeAds July 2019 – May 2020

- Managed web advertising projects end to end, including website builds, PPC funnels, landing pages and lead-generation systems, with detailed time and cost estimates for each.
- Managed the technical implementation of a private CPA network on the HasOffers/Tune platform, including conversion tracking through postbacks and pixels.
- Led a company-wide initiative to build a knowledge base and introduce Git version control.

Tools: WordPress, PHP, Google Analytics, Monday.com, Git, Slack

Contract Web Developer

Ryders Eyewear November 2016 – November 2019

- Maintained and extended the brand's direct-to-consumer WordPress/WooCommerce store.
- Reverse-engineered and rebuilt the store's automated build and deployment pipeline, with containerized local development in Lando and dev, test and live environments on Pantheon.
- Delivered features covering third-party marketing and tracking integrations, checkout changes and catalogue restructuring.
- Produced MySQL reports for business analysis.

Tools: WordPress, WooCommerce, PHP, Pantheon, Lando, Docker, Git, MySQL, Gulp

Web Developer

The Rand Group June 2017 – October 2018

- Managed and developed the company's own sites, RandGroup.com and Dynamics101.com, and client sites including HoustonSymphony.org, itsolutions.bdo.ca and LSRetail.com for a Microsoft Dynamics solutions partner.
- Built responsive front ends in Bootstrap 3 and 4, added multilingual support with WPML, and integrated marketing automation through ClickDimensions and Microsoft CRM.
- Provided monthly maintenance, updates and cross-browser compatibility reporting.

Tools: WordPress, Microsoft CRM, Microsoft Azure, WPML, jQuery, Bootstrap 4, Asana

Web Developer

Noble Pixels 2017 – 2018

- Developed CMS interfaces for user stories across three production applications in an in-house Agile environment.
- Created and modified REST API endpoints consumed by reusable Vue.js components.
- Built admin reporting tables and interfaces using Eloquent ORM and raw SQL.

Tools: Laravel, Vue.js, MySQL, jQuery, Git

Developer

Soulpepper March 2016 – March 2018

- Managed and developed the agency's Magento store, RoderickAllan.com, and set up its Git deployment workflow on Beanstalk.
- Integrated third-party stock data from Google Sheets into Magento with Magmi through a custom PHP cron job.
- Wrote project proposals for prospective clients and worked alongside SEO, PPC and marketing specialists on campaign tracking.

Tools: Magento, PHP, MySQL, Beanstalk, Git

Web Developer & Consultant

James Higgins Web Development 2013 – present

- Design, build and maintain WordPress sites for agencies and direct clients, from scoping and estimates through launch and ongoing support.
- Build and support e-commerce stores on WooCommerce, Shopify and Magento, including custom checkout, catalogue and third-party integrations.
- Develop and maintain DevOps implementations for client projects: Git-based workflows, containerized local environments, staged dev, test and live deployments, and automated builds.
- Hold every build to professional standards, with clean version history, documented handovers, and attention to performance and security.

Tools: WordPress, WooCommerce, PHP, Shopify, Magento, MySQL, Git, Docker, Lando

Skills

DELIVERY

Scoping & estimation, Backlog & release management, Stakeholder reporting, Agile & Kanban, Partner & vendor coordination, DevOps strategy, UX & UI direction, Team leadership

ENGINEERING

WordPress & WooCommerce, PHP & Laravel, JavaScript, Vue.js & React, REST APIs, SQL, HTML, CSS & Sass, Magento & Shopify, LAMP / LEMP

Tools: Jira, Basecamp, Asana, Monday.com, Trello, Microsoft Teams, Git, Docker, Lando, Linux, WP Engine, Pantheon, Microsoft Azure, Kentico, Sitefinity.

Education

Applied Web Development

British Columbia Institute of Technology

BA, Philosophy

University of British Columbia